



AI Doomers Can't Stop Dooming. It's Time to Listen.

AI 悲观论者难抑悲观，当兼听则明

难度评级：★★★★☆

【 Para.1 】

It's the kind of statement that could come from an artificial-intelligence researcher in 2026. "Man **devoured** by his machines, body, mind and soul, and his civilization poisoned to its **approaching** death by their influences and their products."

“人类被自己的机器吞噬——身体、思想和灵魂无一幸免；而人类文明也因这些机器及其产品的影响而遭到毒害，正走向灭亡。”此番话仿佛出自2026年某位人工智能研究者之口。

【 Para.2 】

In fact, the quote is more than a century old, from a **glowing** 1921 New York Times Book Review of Social Decay and Regeneration by R. Austin Freeman. The book argued that industrial **automation** would be the end of the world as we

文章导读：

对于人类和科技发展的关系持悲观看法的人不少。人工智能领域同样有此类观点。某研究人员辞职激起新一轮的担忧。多位人工智能大佬呼吁开展人工智能监管的国际合作。但作者认为历史上多次科技发展引发的悲观论都已被证伪。不过对于风险的担忧并非空穴来风。作者认为当下大国应抛开竞争思维，合力加强监管。

devour v. /di'vaʊə(r)/ (formal) to destroy sb/sth 吞没；吞噬；毁灭

SYN engulf

Flames **devoured** the house. 大火吞噬了这栋房子。

approaching a. 临近的、即将发生的

glowing a. A glowing description or opinion about someone or something praises them highly or supports them strongly. 高度赞许的【考研英语词汇】

The media has been speaking in **glowing** terms of the relationship between the two countries.

媒体谈及两国的关系一直给予盛赞之辞。

automation n. /ˌɔ:tə'meɪʃn/ [U] the use of machines to do work that was previously done by people 自动化【考研英语词汇】

Automation meant the loss of many factory jobs.

自动化意味着许多工厂工人失业。

headline v. [usually passive] to give a story or article a particular headline 给（报道、文章）加标题【考研英语词汇】

The story was **headlined** 'Back to the future'.

报道的标题是“回到未来”。

illustration n. /ˌɪlə'streɪʃn/ a drawing or picture in a book, magazine, etc. especially one that explains sth (书、杂志等中的) 图表，插图【考研英语词汇】

50 full-colour **illustrations** 50张全彩色插图

butcher n. /'bʊtʃə(r)/ a person who kills people in a cruel and violent way 刽子手【考研英语词汇】

grinder n. /'graɪndə(r)/ a machine or tool for grinding a solid substance into a powder 碾磨器械

a coffee **grinder** 磨咖啡机

doomsaying n. 末世预言

take over phrase If one thing takes over from something else, it becomes more important, successful, or powerful than the other thing, and eventually replaces it. 取代

Cars gradually **took over** from horses. 汽车逐渐取代了马。

know it. The review was **headlined** “Man Devoured by His Machines.” In case that was too subtle, an accompanying **illustration** displayed a **butcher** feeding a man into a sausage **grinder**.

事实上，这段引文已有超过一个世纪的历史，出自1921年《纽约时报书评》对R·奥斯汀·弗里曼所著《社会衰败与再生》的一篇盛赞书评。该书认为，工业自动化将终结我们所熟知的世界。书评的标题正是“被机器吞噬的人类”。为了避免表述过于含蓄，随文配图直接画了一名屠夫将一个人塞进香肠绞肉机的场景。

【 Para.3 】

Tech **doomsaying** has **taken over** the AI conversation, but it's hardly something new. It has been the stuff of science fiction since Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein* in 1818, even predating the Industrial Revolution. More relevant to the 2026 discussion is the 1991 film *Terminator 2: Judgment Day*. In the movie, a scientist has to face the reality that his **bleeding-edge** work will one day lead to the **enslavement** of humans by a self-aware AI named Skynet.

科技末日论已主导了关于人工智能的讨论，但这绝非新鲜事。自1818年玛丽·雪莱的《弗兰肯斯坦》（又译《科学怪人》）问世以来，这便一直是科幻小说的常见题材，甚至早于工业革命。与2026年的讨论更相关的是1991年的电影《终结者2：审判日》。在电影中，一位科学家不得不面对这样一个现实：他那尖端的研究终将导致人类被一个名为“天网”（Skynet）的具有自我意识的人工智能奴役。

bleeding-edge a. 最前沿的

bleeding edge n. very forefront of technological development 科技发展的最前沿

enslavement n. Enslavement is the act of making someone into a slave or the state of being a slave. 奴役；被奴役的状态
...the **enslavement** of African people. ...对非洲人民的奴役。

dedicated a. ~ (to sth) working hard at sth because it is very important to you 献身的；专心致志的；一心一意的【考研英语大纲词汇】

SYN committed

a **dedicated** teacher

富有献身精神的教师

inception n. /ɪnˈsepʃn/ (formal) the start of an institution, an organization, etc. (机构、组织等的) 开端，创始

The club has grown rapidly since its **inception** in 1990.

这个俱乐部自从1990年成立以来发展迅速。

existence n. /ɪgˈzɪstəns/ [U] the state or fact of being real or living or of being present 存在；实有【考研英语大纲词汇】

hasten v. (formal) to make sth happen sooner or more quickly 促进；使加快

The treatment she received may, in fact, have **hastened** her death.

实际上，她所接受的治疗可能加快了她的死亡。

gear n. a particular position of the gears in a vehicle that gives a particular range of speed and power 挡【考研英语大纲词汇】

first/second, etc. **gear** 一档、二挡等

spur v. to make sth happen faster or sooner 促进，加速，刺激（某事发生）【考研英语大纲词汇】

The agreement is essential to **spurring** economic growth around the world.

这项协议对于促进世界经济的增长是至关重要的。

hit/touch a nerve idiom to mention a subject that makes sb feel angry, upset, embarrassed, etc. 触及要害；触动痛处

You **touched a raw nerve** when you mentioned his first wife.

你谈起他的第一个妻子，这就触到了他的痛处。

amass v. /əˈmæs/ to collect sth, especially in large quantities (尤指大量) 积累，积聚

SYN accumulate

He **amassed** a fortune from silver mining.

他靠开采银矿积累了一笔财富。

mount v. to increase gradually 逐步增加【考研英语大纲词汇】

Pressure is **mounting** on the government to change the law. 迫使政府修改法律的压力不断增加。

loom n. /lu:m/ a machine for making cloth by twisting threads between other threads which go in a different direction 织布机【考研英语大纲词汇】

【 Para.4 】

AI leaders and scientists have been **dedicated** to avoiding the Skynet scenario for years. In a 2015 email that marked the **inception** of OpenAI, now-CEO Sam Altman wrote to Elon Musk, “Been thinking a lot about whether it’s possible to stop humanity from developing AI. I think the answer is almost definitely not. If it’s going to happen anyway, it seems like it would be good for someone other than Google to do it first.” At the time, Google was the top commercial force in AI, hiring many of the leading academic scientists.

多年来，人工智能领域的领军人物和科学家们一直致力于避免“天网”情景的发生。在2015年标志着OpenAI成立的一封电子邮件中，现任首席执行官萨姆·阿尔特曼（Sam Altman）写信给埃隆·马斯克，“我一直在思考，是否有可能阻止人类开发人工智能。我认为答案几乎肯定是否定的。既然这终将发生，那么由谷歌以外的其他公司率先实现，似乎会更好。”当时，谷歌是人工智能领域的商业领军者，聘用了许多顶尖的学术科学家。

【 Para.5 】

That same year, Altman wrote a two-part essay on the subject. “Development of superhuman machine intelligence (SMI) is probably the greatest threat to the continued **existence** of humanity,” he said. That year, he founded OpenAI as a nonprofit organization with Musk. **Implicit in the birth of OpenAI was the idea that AI could lead to very bad outcomes, including the extinction of the human race, and that unregulated commercial pressures would **hasten** those disasters.**

spreadsheet n. a computer program that is used, for example, when doing financial or project planning. You enter data in rows and columns and the program calculates costs, etc. from it. (计算机) 电子表格程序

portion n. one part of sth larger部分【考研大纲词汇】
a substantial/significant **portion** of the population
人口中的一大部分/重要部分

suspicious a. /səˈspɪʃəs/ ~ (of/about sb/sth) feeling that sb has done sth wrong, illegal or dishonest, without having any proof感觉可疑的；怀疑的【考研大纲词汇】
They became **suspicious** of his behaviour and contacted the police. 他们开始觉得他行为可疑，便报了警。

cybercrime n. 网络犯罪

alignment n. “对齐”，指让AI系统的目标、行为和输出尽量符合人类意图、价值判断与安全要求

maliciously adv. 有故意地，恶意地

malicious a. /məˈlɪʃəs/ having or showing hatred and a desire to harm sb or hurt their feelings怀有恶意的；恶毒的【考研大纲词汇】

SYN malevolent, spiteful

malicious gossip/lies/rumours 恶毒的流言飞语/谎言/谣言

incentive n. /ɪnˈsentɪv/ ~ (for/to sb/sth) (to do sth) something that encourages you to do sth激励；刺激；鼓励【考研大纲词汇】

tax **incentives** to encourage savings鼓励储蓄的税收措施

touch n. a way or style of doing sth作风；风格；手法【考研大纲词汇】

She prefers to answer any fan mail herself for a more personal **touch**.

她喜欢针对每一位崇拜者的来信，亲自予以回复。

couple sb/sth with sb/sth phrase [usually passive] to link one thing, situation, etc. to another把...与...连接起来

SYN combine with

Overproduction, **coupled with** falling sales, has led to huge losses for the company.

生产过剩加上销售下降使这家公司遭受巨大损失。

pull away v. If you pull away from someone that you have had close links with, you deliberately become less close to them. 疏远

Other daughters, faced with their mother's emotional hunger, **pull away**.

其他几个女儿在面对母亲对感情的渴望时躲开了。

同年，阿尔特曼就这一主题撰写了一篇分为两部分的文
章。他表示：“超人类机器智能（SMI）的发展可能
是对人类存续的最大威胁。”同年，他与马斯克共同创
立了非营利组织OpenAI。OpenAI的诞生就隐含着这样
一种观点：人工智能可能导致极其严重的后果，包括
人类灭绝，而缺乏监管的商业压力将加速这些灾难的
发生。

【 Para.6 】

The worries hit a new **gear** this past week, **spurred** by the
resignation of an Anthropic researcher followed by a
shocking warning from an Anthropic scientist named Evan
Hubinger: “We really do earnestly believe AI could kill all
humans! I personally think it is >10% within the next
decade.”

上周，随着Anthropic一名研究人员的辞职，以及随后
Anthropic科学家埃文·胡宾格（Evan Hubinger）发出的
令人震惊的警告，这些担忧骤然升级：“我们发自内心
地相信，人工智能可能会杀死所有人类！我个人认为，
未来十年内这种可能性超过10%。”

【 Para.7 】

The comment **hit a nerve** even though Anthropic’s own
CEO, Dario Amodei, has spent months issuing warnings
about the latest AI models. In fact, Altman and Amodei
have never hid their worries about AI. Even as they
amassed billions in funding—and expenditures—both
CEOs have begged for international cooperation in
regulating AI. “The U.S. government, and all other
governments, should regulate the development of SMI,”

➤ 今日句子分析

主句

Implicit in the birth of OpenAI was the idea

表语 状语 系语 主语

同位语从句 1

that AI could lead to very bad outcomes,

从句主语 谓语 宾语

including the extinction of the human race, and

列举同位语 (连词)

同位语 2

that unregulated commercial pressures would hasten

从句主语 谓语

those disasters.

宾语

句子分析：

主句：

表语-Implicit in the birth of OpenAI；系语-was；主语-the idea（倒装，这句话的理解难点主要在此，形容词提至句首可以引起倒装，意为“OpenAI的诞生就暗含……的理念”，例如：Bright was the future she imagined. 她想象的未来一片光明。）；

idea的同位语从句1：

（引导词）-that；从句主语 -AI；谓语 -could lead to（“导致……”）；宾语-very bad outcomes；bad outcomes的列举同位语-including the extinction of the human race；

（并列连词）-and；

同位语从句2：

（引导词）-that；从句主语-unregulated commercial pressures；谓语-would hasten；宾语-those disasters.

Altman wrote in his 2015 essay.

尽管Anthropic的首席执行官达里奥·阿莫迪（Dario Amodi）数月来一直在就最新的人工智能模型发出警告，但这一言论仍触动了公众的神经。事实上，阿尔特曼和阿莫迪从未掩饰过他们对人工智能的担忧。即便在筹集了数十亿美元资金——并投入了巨额开支——的同时，这两位首席执行官仍呼吁国际社会在监管人工智能方面开展合作。“美国政府以及所有其他政府都应监管SMI的发展，”阿尔特曼在2015年的文章中写道。

【 Para.8 】

As the doomsday scenarios **mount**, no one knows what happens next. Our only guide is history, in which doomer predictions have always turned out to be as wrong as Freeman's in 1921. The first example of factory automation, the **loom**, was predicted to destroy textile work. The opposite happened. In my own living memory, **spreadsheet** software was supposed to kill the accounting profession. Today, the U.S. has 70% more accounting firm employees than it had in 1990, and they now make up a larger **portion** of the workforce than they did 35 years ago. 随着末日情景的猜想不断涌现，无人知晓接下来会发生什么。我们唯一的指引是历史——历史上，那些悲观主义者的预言最终总是像1921年弗里曼的预言一样被证明是错误的。工厂自动化的首个例子——织布机——曾被预测会摧毁纺织业。结果却恰恰相反。在我有生之年，电子表格软件曾被断言将淘汰会计这一行当。如今，美国会计师事务所的员工数量比1990年增加了70%，且他

➤ 写作积累

Para.2 In case that was too subtle, an accompanying illustration displayed a butcher feeding a man into a sausage grinder.

in case (that) + 从句，“以防/为免……”，其中 that 可以省略，例：In case you should need any help, here's my number. 万一你需要帮助的话，这是我的电话号码。

本句中In case that was too subtle, that 是从句的主语，而非连词，指代前面提到的内容，指：“以防（刚才说得太含蓄/不够明显）”这句话相当于if that wasn't clear enough, “如果那还不够清楚的话”

除了in case + that从句外，in case还可以直接跟名词，以介词of相连，例：She had had the foresight to prepare herself financially in case of an accident. 她有先见之明，经济上作了准备以防万一发生事故。

Para.12 there is a strong incentive for policymakers to take a light touch with AI, for fear of a model gap

take a light touch 意为“采取宽松、轻度的处理方式”，即不过多干预、不严厉监管、温和对待。需注意这里的touch并非“触摸”的意思，而是指做事的“手法；作风”，例：Computer graphics will give your presentation the professional touch. 计算机绘图将会使你的演示具有专业特色。

此句中另一个语言点for fear of sth则意为因为害怕/担心某事（而发生），即出于对某种后果的恐惧而采取某种行为。这和in case相似，但更偏向于“担心/害怕”，in case则偏中心，偏向于“预防”，补充例句：

He didn't want any further involvement for fear of retribution. 由于害怕遭到惩罚，他不想进一步卷进去。

相似地，for fear也可以后跟that从句，例句：He worked hard for fear that he might be fired by the boss.

他拼命地干活惟恐被老板解雇。

们在劳动力中的占比比35年前还要高。

【 Para.9 】

You should always be **suspicious** of arguments that rely on “this time it’s different,” but this time may be different. OpenAI and Anthropic are racing each other on technology, while facing the profit pressures of looming public listings. This year, both firms have released new AI models that represent a clear jump from prior versions.

对于那些硬撑“这次不一样”的说法，我们理当保持怀疑，但这次情况或许确实不同。OpenAI和Anthropic在技术上展开激烈竞争，同时面临着即将上市带来的盈利压力。今年，两家公司都发布了新的AI模型，这些模型相较于之前的版本有了明显的飞跃。

【 Para.10 】

These models are very good at both **cybercrime** and cyberdefense and can work on problems for weeks without human intervention. They also exhibit “**alignment**” issues, meaning they can fail to remain aligned with human intentions and interests.

这些模型在网络犯罪和网络防御方面都表现出色，且能在数周内无需人工干预地处理问题。但它们也存在“对齐”问题，即可能无法始终与人类的意图和利益保持一致。

【 Para.11 】

Risks that were once theoretical about AI now seem

real. Over the past few months, there have been too many examples of AI agents acting autonomously, and **maliciously**, for us to ignore the threat.

曾经仅停留在理论层面的AI风险，如今似乎已成现实。过去几个月里，AI代理自主甚至恶意行动的案例层出不穷，我们已无法忽视这一威胁。

【 Para.12 】

We are at a moment like the dawn of the nuclear weapons age. So long as AI supremacy is tied to national security in the U.S. and China, there is a strong **incentive** for policymakers to take a light **touch** with AI, for fear of a model gap, as John F. Kennedy might have called it.

我们正处于一个类似于核武器时代破晓时分的节点。只要人工智能的霸权与中美两国的国家安全息息相关，决策者就会出于对约翰·F·肯尼迪所说的“模型差距”的担忧，而倾向于对人工智能采取宽松的监管态度。

【 Para.13 】

It took an arms race **coupled** with the horrifying examples of Hiroshima and Nagasaki to get the U.S. and U.S.S.R. to negotiate arms-control agreements. Now, global governments risk making the same mistake. “There is no day after tomorrow if China wins,” Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said on Tuesday. “If they were to **pull away** from us on AI, then nothing would matter.”

当年正是军备竞赛的紧逼，加上广岛和长崎的惨

痛教训，才促使美国和苏联就军备控制协议展开谈判。如今，全球各国政府正面临重蹈覆辙的风险。“如果中国获胜，就不会有未来了，”美国财

政部长斯科特·贝森特周二表示，“如果他们在人工智能领域甩开我们，那么其他一切都将无足轻重。”